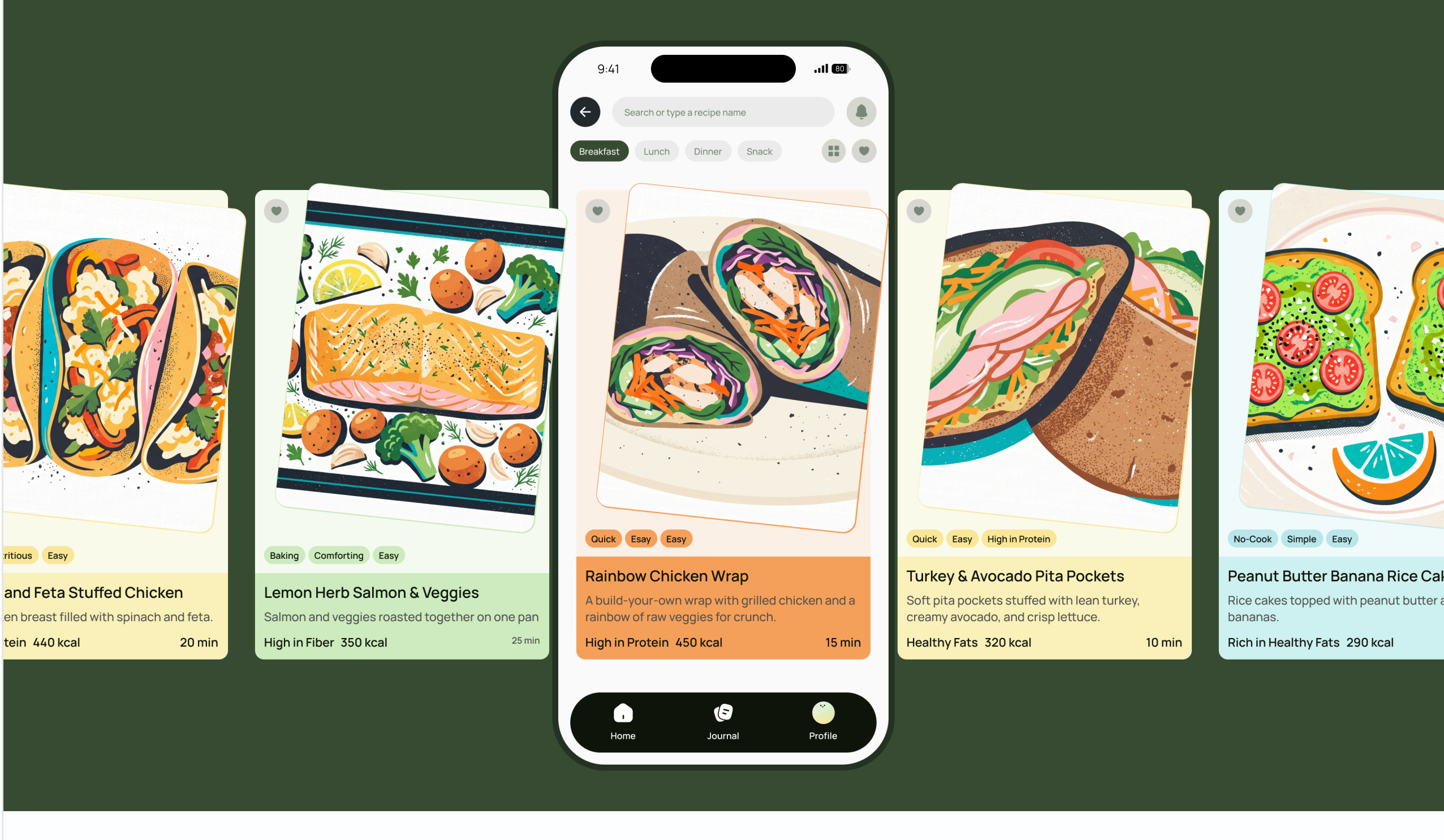

Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Snack
and Feta Stuffed Chicken
Lemon Herb Salmon & Veggies
Salmon and veggies roasted together on one pan
High in Fiber 350 kcal
Rainbow Chicken Wrap
A build-your-own wrap with grilled chicken and a rainbow of raw veggies for crunch.
High in Protein 450 kcal 15 min
Turkey & Avocado Pita Pockets
Soft pita pockets stuffed with lean turkey, creamy avocado, and crisp lettuce.
Healthy Fats 320 kcal 10 min
Peanut Butter Banana Rice C
Home
Journal
Profile

THE FAMILY TABLE UI/UX DESIGN 2025

A weekly family meal everyone wants to be part of

ROLE	TIMELINE	TYPE	TOOLS
Solo designer. Research framing, UX, UI, art direction.	10 hours, timed challenge	Concept feature. Designed, not built or user-tested.	Figma

THE BRIEF

Ten hours to pick one problem and design a feature that answers it.

HeyNouri gave four candidate problems drawn from parents using meal-prep apps. I chose the fourth, and the one with the least obvious feature attached to it.

The other three problems have known solutions. Faster planning, smarter substitutions, better nutrition labelling. Problem 04 was a parent saying they wanted their kids involved in food, not just fed by it. Nothing in a recipe library answers that.

This was a timed exercise, so the honest scope matters. There was no access to HeyNouri users, no analytics, and no round of testing inside the window. Everything below is design reasoning from the brief and from competitive behaviour I could observe. Where a claim would need evidence I do not have, I have said so rather than dressed it up.

THE PROBLEM

A meal runs through five stages. Meal-prep apps show up for two of them.

I mapped the meal as a repeating weekly loop rather than a single planning task. Once it is drawn that way, the gap is hard to miss. Decide and Shop are well covered. Cook, Serve and Reflect are still one adult working alone, and the kid has a pain point in every column.

	Decide	Shop	Cook	Serve	Reflect
Parent pain-point	Tries to find a meal everyone will agree on.	Keeps track of the list, cost, and dietary needs alone.	Juggles timing, tasks, and the kitchen alone.	Gets everything on the table while everyone waits.	Has no easy way to remember what worked.
Child pain-point	Feels left out of the decision.	Gets bored or left behind while shopping.	Is kept out of the kitchen for safety.	Gets food they didn't expect or choose.	Shares an opinion once, then it's forgotten.
Needs	A meal everyone helps choose.	A clear role and ownership of the list.	Tasks that match each person's ability.	Recognition for everyone who helped.	A shared memory of the meal.
Opportunity	Choose the meal together.	Make the list together.	Turn the recipe into roles.	Make contribution visible.	Capture what matters.

Journey map built from the brief. The child row is the one that changed the direction of the work. Every stage already has a kid in it, doing nothing.

WHO IT IS FOR

Primary: kids and teens roughly 8 to 16 who want a real job, not a chore. Secondary: the parent carrying the whole meal alone.

WHAT I ASSUMED

Supervised phone access for kids. Parents keep veto power over nutrition and budget. Both assumptions are stated because both are load bearing.

WHY IT MATTERS

The habit a parent actually wants is confidence around food. That transfers through doing, and the product currently gives kids nothing to do.

THE INSIGHT

Participation is the one thing a recipe app cannot hand you.

A meal planner can hand a parent a decision. It cannot hand a family a shared activity, because the activity is the thing being replaced. Every efficiency the category adds removes one more reason for a second person to be in the room.

So the problem is not that kids lack a kids' mode. It is that the meal has no roles in it. One account holder decides, buys, cooks, serves and remembers. Everyone else waits and receives.

> A family meal already repeats every week. It does not need a new habit. It needs roles.
>
> THE REFRAME THE REST OF THE WORK FOLLOWS FROM

THE DECISION

I gave every stage a role instead of building a separate kids' section.

The obvious ten-hour answer is a walled kids' area. A profile toggle, softer illustrations, simpler recipes. I did not take it, for one reason. A separate section makes participation optional, and optional participation is exactly the current state.

THE REJECTED OPTION

A kids' mode sitting beside the main app. Easy to build, easy to demo, and easy to ignore after week two. It also leaves the parent's five stages untouched, which is where the actual load sits.

WHAT I DESIGNED INSTEAD

Four touch points across the existing flow, each one handing a stage to someone who was previously waiting. Choosing, listing, cooking and remembering. The parent keeps veto, not ownership of every step.

THE DESIGN

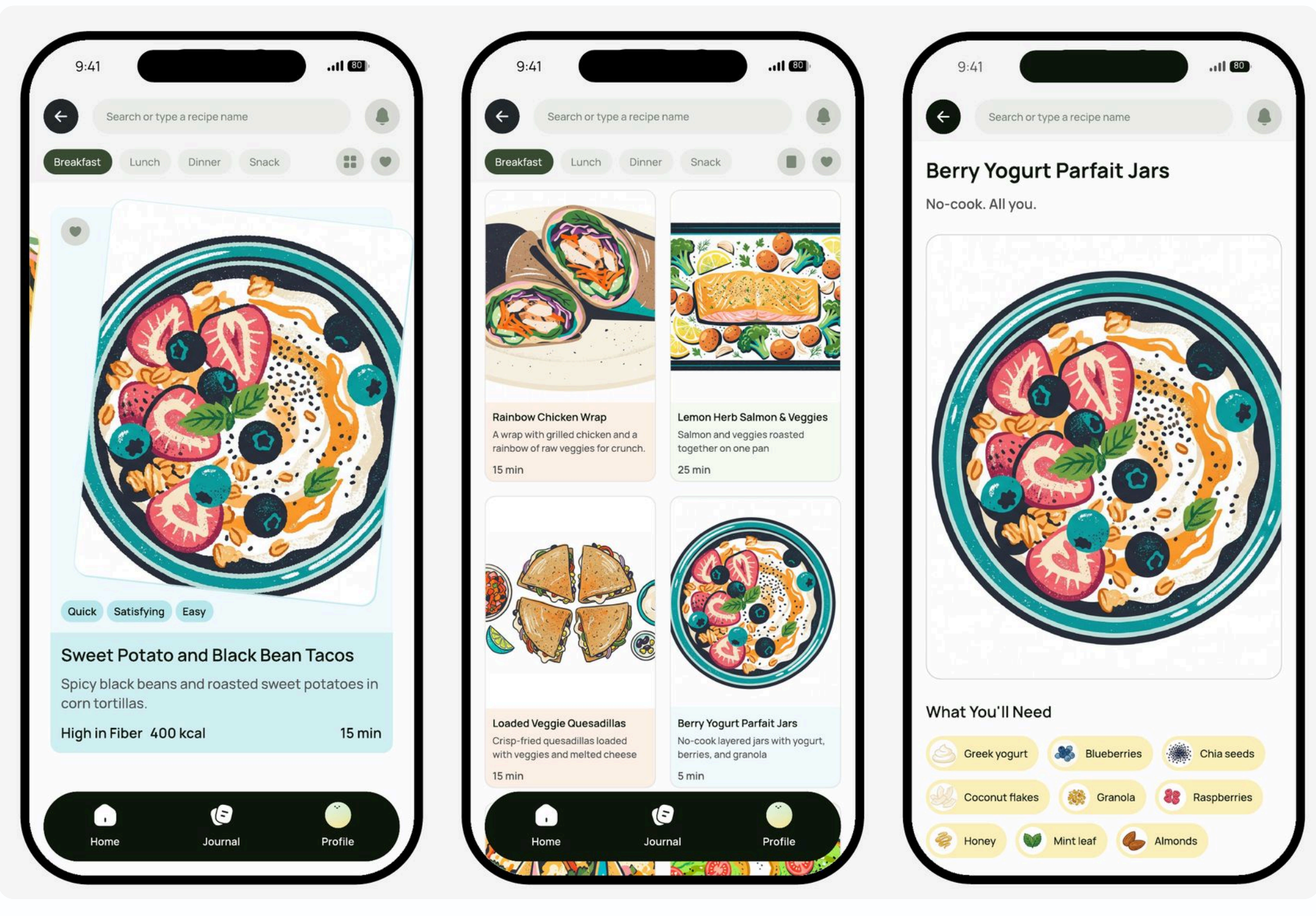
Four moments where the meal stops belonging to one person.

Decide · One card decides how the meal starts

Meal time comes before search. The real question is what is for dinner tonight, not search all recipes, so the first filter is Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, Snack and the default view is one large card at a time.

A card sized for one hand and one decision is a card a kid can be handed. That is the actual reason for the format. The grid is there for the parent scanning fast.

Protein, calories and cook time sit on the card face rather than behind a tab, so the nutrition conversation happens while choosing instead of after committing.


9:41
Search or type a recipe name
Breakfast
Lunch
Dinner
Snack
Quick
Satisfying
Easy
Sweet Potato and Black Bean Tacos
Spicy black beans and roasted sweet potatoes in corn tortillas.
High in Fiber 400 kcal 15 min
Rainbow Chicken Wrap
A wrap with grilled chicken and a rainbow of raw veggies for crunch.
15 min
Lemon Herb Salmon & Veggies
Salmon and veggies roasted together on one pan
25 min
Loaded Veggie Quesadillas
Crisp-fried quesadillas loaded with veggies and melted cheese
15 min
Berry Yogurt Parfait Jars
No-cook layered jars with yogurt, berries, and granola
5 min
Berry Yogurt Parfait Jars
No-cook. All you.
What You'll Need
Greek yogurt
Blueberries
Chia seeds
Coconut flakes
Granola
Raspberries
Honey
Mint leaf
Almonds
Home
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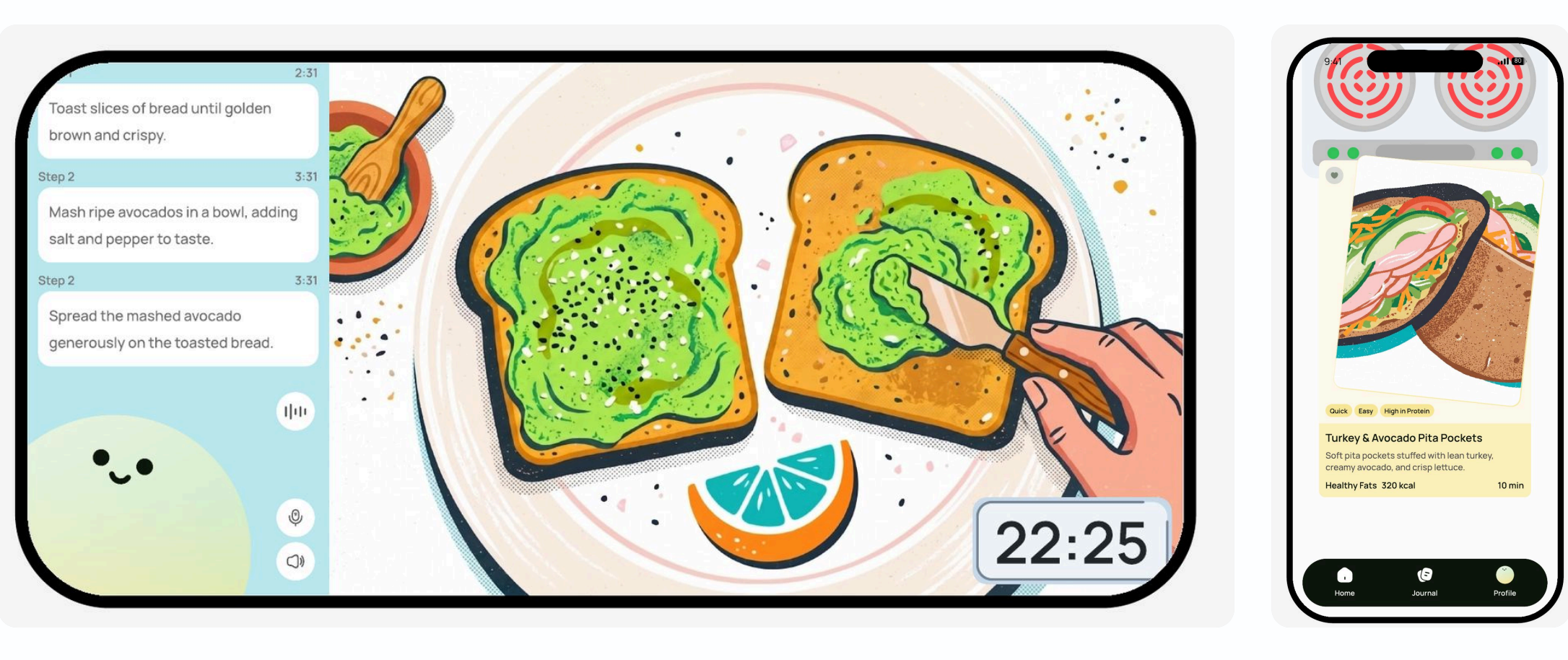
Cook · Turning the phone is the mode switch

Rotating to landscape drops the recipe into Cook Mode. A character reads each step out loud and takes questions mid recipe, so the kid asking what does simmer mean gets an answer from the app rather than from a parent who has both hands busy.

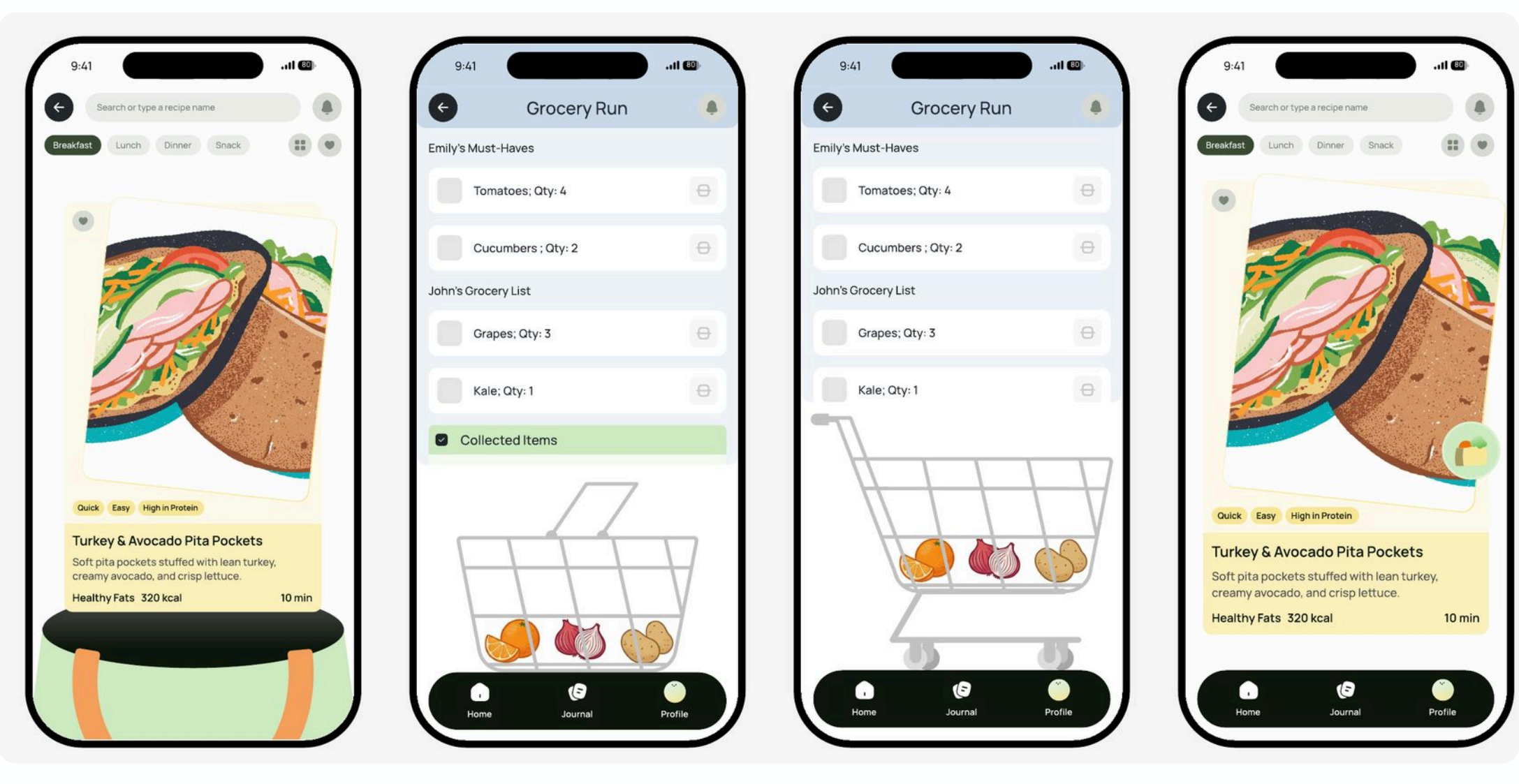
No new button, no new place to find. The gesture a kid already makes when they want something to be a video is the gesture that hands them the recipe.

This is the screen carrying the most risk in the whole concept, and the one I would test first. See trade-offs below.


2:31
Toast slices of bread until golden brown and crispy.
Step 2 3:31
Mash ripe avocados in a bowl, adding salt and pepper to taste.
Step 2 3:31
Spread the mashed avocado generously on the toasted bread.
22:25
Turkey & Avocado Pita Pockets

Shop · The list does not close when one person finishes it

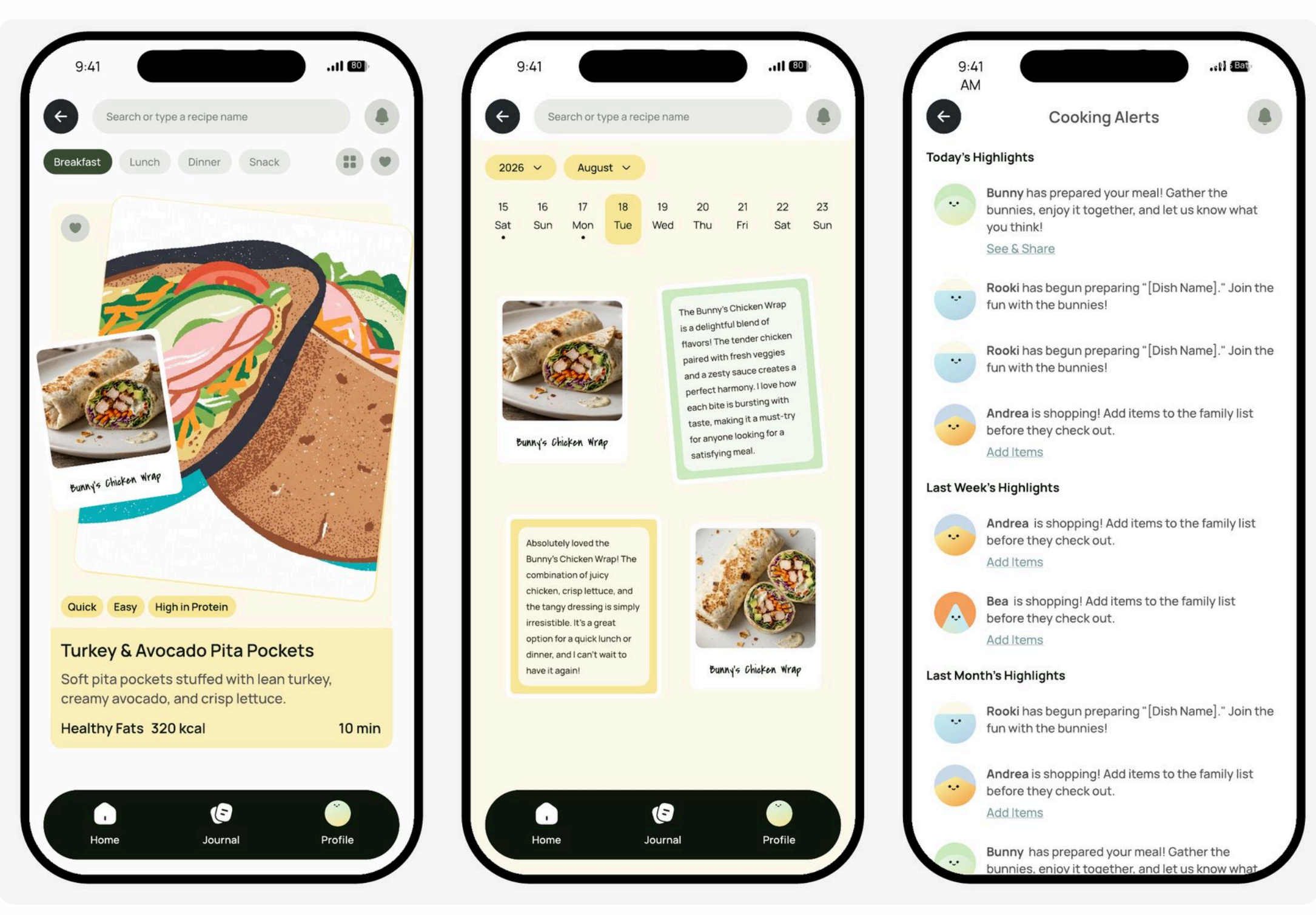
Selecting a recipe drops its ingredients into a shared list. Every family member can add from wherever they are, including mid shop, because someone always remembers one more thing after the list feels done. Items stay grouped by who added them, which is the small move that turns a chore list into a visible contribution.



Serve and Reflect · The meal does not end at the plate

Cooking Alerts let the household follow along live. Who is shopping, who has started cooking, when the food is ready. After the meal, whoever cooked photographs it and leaves a note, and the app keeps a running journal of what the family actually liked.

This is the stage no competitor covers, and it is also the cheapest one to build. It reuses the recipe, the photo and one text field.



The Bunny's Chicken Wrap is a delightful blend of flavors! The tender chicken paired with fresh veggies and a zesty sauce creates a perfect harmony. I love how each bite is bursting with taste, making it a must-try for anyone looking for a satisfying meal.

Absolutely loved the Bunny's Chicken Wrap! The combination of juicy chicken, crisp lettuce, and the tangy dressing is simply irresistible. It's a great option for a quick lunch or dinner, and I can't wait to have it again!

Bunny has prepared your meal! Gather the bunnies, enjoy it together, and let us know what you think!

Rooki has begun preparing "[Dish Name]." Join the fun with the bunnies!

Rooki has begun preparing "[Dish Name]." Join the fun with the bunnies!

Andrea is shopping! Add items to the family list before they check out.

Andrea is shopping! Add items to the family list before they check out.

Bea is shopping! Add items to the family list before they check out.

Rooki has begun preparing "[Dish Name]." Join the fun with the bunnies!

Andrea is shopping! Add items to the family list before they check out.

CAMPAIGN

COOKING IS FUN WHEN DONE TOGETHER!

The creative sells the feeling, not the feature.

No screenshots and no UI in the frame. If The Family Table works, a Tuesday looks like this.

The brief asked for a feature. The post sells what the feature produces. A kid old enough to hold the spatula, a parent handing over real trust, one plate at the end of it.

TRADE-OFFS

The gap I would fix before anything else is a safety one.

Ten hours bought four flows and cost me onboarding. There is no step in this concept that captures allergies, dietary needs or household constraints, which means a recipe surfaced to an eight year old is not yet guaranteed to be safe for them to cook or eat. That is a real hole, not a nice to have, and it is the first thing I would design next.

Cook Mode assumes a kid is unsupervised, and I have not proven the guide is good enough for that.

The character needs to call out hot pans and sharp knives clearly enough for a parent to trust it. Untested.

Roles are offered, not enforced.

Nothing stops a parent doing all five stages anyway. Making participation the default rather than the invitation is unresolved.

No user research and no testing inside the window.

The journey map is reasoned from the brief. Both the child pain points and the age range are assumptions I would want to check.

Nutrition on the card face is a bet.

Surfacing calories at the moment of choosing helps a parent. Whether that is the right thing to put in front of a twelve year old every night is a question I would want a specialist on.

VALIDATION

Three signals would tell me whether roles actually transferred.

Grocery additions from more than one family member, after the list already felt done.

The cleanest proof that the list stopped belonging to one person.

Cook Mode sessions started from a kid's profile, not a parent's.

Started, and finished. A session a parent takes over halfway is a failed session.

Whether the stages that ask most of a kid hold up without an adult stepping in.

Run Cook Mode start to finish with a real 8 to 16 year old and a parent watching but not helping.

Further out, the direction I would most want to explore is cuisine based discovery, where a family travels by cooking a different region's food each week. Cooking a place's food is one of the more honest ways to understand it, and it gives the weekly loop a reason to keep going once the novelty of roles wears off.

REFLECTION

WHAT THE PROJECT TAUGHT ME

The strongest move here was not a screen. It was refusing the kids' mode.

Choosing the harder structural answer inside a ten hour window meant less polish across four flows, and I would make that trade again, because a walled section would have demoed better and solved nothing.

The other lesson is about journey maps. Adding a second row for the person nobody was designing for is what produced the whole concept. The map was not documentation. It was the argument.

WHAT I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY NOW

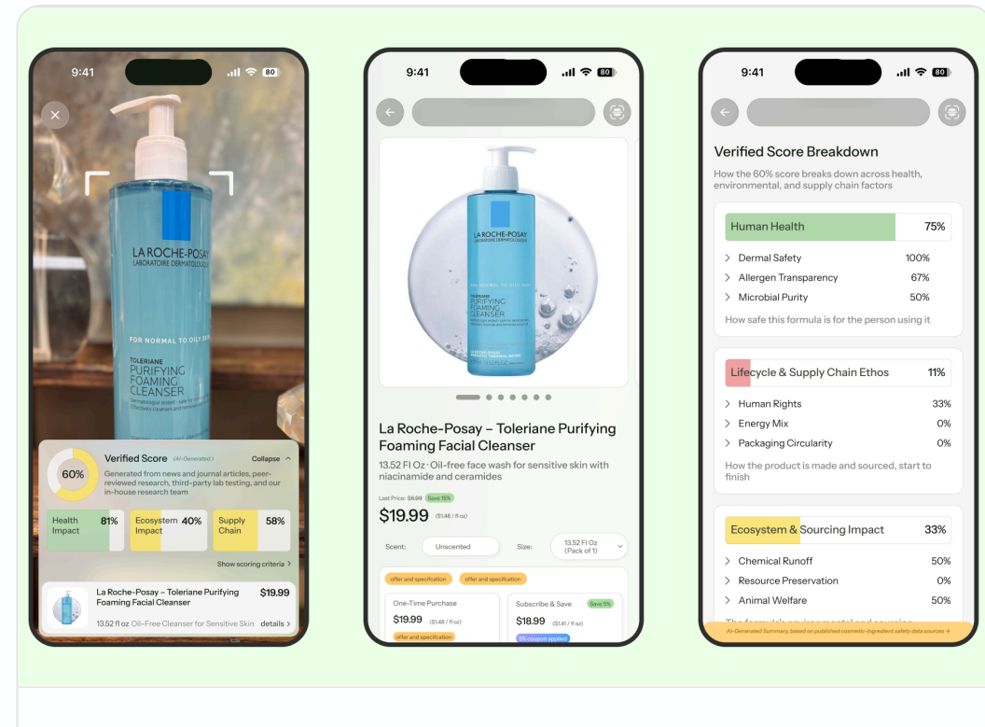
I would spend the first hour on constraints instead of exploration.

Onboarding for allergies would have taken maybe forty minutes and would have closed the one gap that genuinely undermines the concept. Beautiful flows around an unsafe default is the wrong order.

I would also put a rough Cook Mode script in front of one real kid before designing the screen around it, even informally. The voice guide is doing all the work in that flow, and I designed the container before I knew whether the content could hold a nine year old's attention for twenty minutes.

Concept work for the HeyNouri UX/UI design challenge, a ten hour timed exercise. Not affiliated with a shipped HeyNouri release.

ALSO CHECKOUT



GREENERA UI/UX DESIGN 2025

A Product Page That Tells You Which Sustainability Claims To Trust

BILLY & BUDDY SERVICE DESIGN

A Mini Game That Teaches Kids To Tell A Need From A Want, In Two Minutes

Intro
The brief
The problem
The insight
The decision
The design
Campaign
Trade-offs
Validation
Reflection